

PEP Brand Guidelines

Three product directions — Lou & Shannon

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DIRECTION 1

Functional protein drink

PEP Brand Guidelines — Functional Protein Drink

Who PEP is for, and When

PEP is for disciplined, routine-driven people. Think of gym-goers, wellness-focused professionals, or anyone determined to efficiently hit their daily protein goals. PEP is a practical choice for those who want nutrition and taste, but don't want the heaviness or macho vibe of normal protein shakes. People drink PEP:

- After their workout (gym, run, class)
- As a solo, functional snack replacement
- At work for a nutritious, light, satisfying break
- During the day to stay topped up on protein and feel their best

PEP moments are practical, purposeful, mostly alone, and focus on performance and daily achievement — not celebration, indulgence, or socialising.

Approved Adjectives (Personality)

- Clean
- Functional
- Disciplined
- Efficient
- Light
- Modern
- Healthy
- Optimised
- Refreshing

Rejected Vibes

- Bro, macho, or aggressive gym language

- Indulgent, "treat yourself", or party/drinking ritual
 - Childish, playful (e.g. cartoonish icons)
 - Lifestyle excess or brunch/aperitif occasions
 - "Mocktail", "cocktail", or any alcohol/party framing
 - Social group or party photography
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Visual & Copy — DO / DON'T

DO

- Clearly show functional benefit (protein, nutrition) on front of packaging and in content
- Use clean, light backgrounds and a sense of precision
- Highlight the efficiency and lightness of the experience
- Use Didot for premium headlines (PEP wordmark), Montserrat for body, Bebas Neue only for NEW!/badge elements
- Feature solo, active, wellness-oriented people in photography (gym bag, sneakers, desk, not social groups)
- Use brand color palette: deep green, orange, cream, peach, white for hierarchy and clarity
- Place the tagline "Feel good. Have fun." in Brittany Signature script (never headlines)

DON'T

- Don't use party, brunch, or group social setting photography
 - Don't use gym-bro or bulk-up phrases (no "SWOL", "BEAST MODE", "pump")
 - Don't mimic prebiotic sodas, vibrant social drinks, or indulgent treat cues in palette or copy
 - Don't use display script fonts for core claims (only for tagline!)
 - Don't show cups, glassware, or garnishes reminiscent of cocktails/mocktails
 - Never use "drinkpep.com" or US energy/probiotic branding
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In-Line Brands (Primary References)

- **HOLY** — clean, vitamin-enriched, functional benefits up front ([HOLY](#))

- **LMNT** — clinical, utility-first, focused hydration ([LMNT](#))
- **NOCCO** — boldly functional, performance-driven energy/protein ([NOCCO](#))
- **VITAMIN WELL** — health/efficiency, clean label, daily nutrition ([Vitamin Well](#))

Peer Brands Not to Reference (Other Positionings)

- **BLOOM, OLIPOP, Poppi, Alive & Well, Recess, Ole cocktails, Ish, Ever Tree** — all focus on wellness, lifestyle, or social treat moments, NOT functional, disciplined, solo efficiency.
 - **Kin Euphorics, Lyre's, Seedlip** — social/mocktail brands. Ritual/social group use, not daily functional nutrition.
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Anti-References (Hard NOs)

- **Lean Body / Gym RTD (US-style)** — aggressive, macho, intimidating. Not for practical, everyday achievers.
 - **drinkpep.com** — name collision, different US energy/probiotic positioning. Avoid confusion at all costs.
 - **Party/mocktail brands or kids' juice drinks** — overly vibrant, social or childish. Not functional, disciplined, or premium.
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Brand Fit Rules (How to Judge Future Ideas)

1. **Functional benefit front and center:** If it doesn't call out protein/nutrition up front, it doesn't fit.
2. **Visuals must be clean and efficient:** No playful/pastel/party/festival or chunky gym-bro looks.
3. **Solo, disciplined moment:** Messaging must support busy, wellness-driven individuals.
4. **No mocktail/cocktail/party language or cues.**
5. **Color palette and fonts ONLY from brand.json.**
6. **Photography = solo, practical, no staged group brunches or social parties.**
7. **Never use drinkpep.com branding, copy, or trade dress.**

8. **Copy:** clear, direct, positive — but never hyped-up, exaggerated, or slangy.

DIRECTION 2

Lifestyle upgrade

PEP Brand Guidelines — Lifestyle Upgrade Direction (Lou & Shannon)

Who is PEP for?

- **Young professionals & health-conscious urbanites** (20s/30s): people who want daily wellness with enjoyment, not restriction
- **Aspirational, social, stylish individuals:** people who care about self-care, culture, and community; brunch and outdoor moments, not just workouts
- Ideal for: remote workers, brunch-goers, yoga & wellness enthusiasts, conscious socializers

When and where do they drink PEP?

- Morning or afternoon café sessions (in place of a classic soda or kombucha)
- Making coworking and creative sessions feel special
- Balancing a beach day, picnic, or stroll (something light, never heavy)
- After light exercise, yoga, or during a 'treat yourself' break
- Social gatherings or casual meetups with friends

Approved adjectives & personality

- **Refreshing, light, modern, authentic, balanced, premium but approachable, playful, natural, inclusive, warm**
- PEP = friendly, uplifting, and subtly elevated. Never intimidating, clinical, or overly functional.

Rejected vibes (anti-references)

- "Gym protein," "shred," "bulk," "energy boost," or anything aggressive/masculine
- Clinical/technical/medicinal branding (no supplement bottle, bold metallics, Rx copy)
- Kids' soda, anything cartoonish or childish
- Night-life/bar/club neon influence (save festival for future innovation)

- DO NOT copy or draw inspiration from drinkpep.com (energy/probiotic US drink)

Visual design — Do & Don't

DO:

- **Minimal, pastel, and cream palette** — soft peach, cream, warm yellows, modern green accents (see brand.json)
- Real, inviting, daylight-focused photography: fresh, outdoors, communal, or mindful solo moments
- Typography: Didot (elegant serif for main wordmark/headline), Brittany Signature (warm script accents), Montserrat (clean sans for body & stats)
- Clear callout badges (protein, calories) using Montserrat or Bebas Neue. Subtle, not shouty.

DON'T:

- Use bold, high-saturation colors, metallics, or "energy drink" motifs
- Show gyms, weights, working out, or 'performance' scenes
- Overcrowd with functional claims — wellness, not performance
- Use childish or garish layouts
- Emulate competitor drinkpep.com, nor any mass-market sports protein

Copy voice — Do & Don't

DO:

- Friendly, uplifting, inclusive — "This fits my lifestyle," not "achieve your goals"
- Tone: modern, subtly witty, relaxed confidence
- Tagline: "Feel good. Have fun."

DON'T:

- Use restriction, guilt, or optimization language
- Over-index on technical detail (grams of BCAAs, etc.)
- Rely on gym jargon, bro talk, or fitness clichés

Peer Brands: Clear SPLIT

- **inLineBrands:** Brands like Olipop, Recess, Alive & Well, Bloom, Ever Tree, Poppi, Ole Cocktails, Ish — all benchmark the modern, minimal, lifestyle-upgrade role for PEP
- **positioningFitTypeMismatch:** Authentic kombuchas (Yaya, Walker Brothers) — great wellness/lifestyle vibe, but not close on drink format
- **peerBrandsOtherPositionings:** LMNT, NOCCO, Vitamin Well, HOLY (hydration/gym/functional lane); Kin Euphorics, Lyre's, Seedlip (alcohol substitute, social event focus)

Brand Fit Rules (for teams/partners)

- Always uphold a refreshing, modern, aspirational wellness mood
- Never allow gym, performance, or clinical cues in main design/copy
- Use approved fonts and color palette; avoid copycat or generic wellness layouts
- Celebrate lifestyle occasions: brunch, beach, coworking — YES; gym, bar, or club — NO
- Keep messaging focused on joy, lightness, and self-image, not discipline or maximum function

DIRECTION 3

Better social drink

PEP Brand Guidelines – Better Social Drink Positioning

Who PEP Is For — Social, Experiential Adults

PEP is crafted for sociable adults (18–35), trendsetters and urbanites who crave memorable nights out, rooftop gatherings, and lively group occasions. It is for those who want a premium, delicious option that makes the ritual of "going out for drinks" exciting again—without the alcohol, the excess sugar, or the childish vibes. PEP invites you to feel good and have fun, with a drink that's made for vibrant social moments.

PEP is NOT:

- A gym RTD, sports or recovery drink
- A strictly functional or supplement product
- A health/wellness beverage for solo rituals, or a kid's soda

Core Occasions and Moments

- Bars, restaurants, and trendy cafés (as the "I want something fun but not boozy" option)
- Rooftop or outdoor parties, festival nights, late dinners, group celebrations, stylish daytime events
- Dates, friends' gatherings, brunches with a "let's make it special" feel
- Instagrammable nights and selfie-ready moments

Personality & Adjectives

Approved:

- Social
- Euphoric
- Fun
- Premium
- Vibrant
- Aesthetic

- Trend-forward
- Fresh

Rejected:

- Clinical
- Sporty
- Functional
- Supplement
- Childlike/kiddy
- Gym-centric
- Wellness-washed
- Minimalist/sterile

Visual & Copy DO / DON'T

Visual DO:

- Use festival-inspired, bold color combos (see brand.json), high-energy gradients, and fruit elements
- Focus on premium, striking packaging (metallic finishes, rich label textures, beautiful cans/bottles that stand out in bars)
- Scenes and photography must feature real social occasions: diverse, stylish groups, evening light, joyous energy
- Typography: Elegant Didot logotype, Montserrat for clarity, expressive signature script for taglines
- Layouts should feel lively but grown-up: think nightlife, events, celebration—not party-store or childish

Visual DON'T:

- Avoid muted pastels, white-on-white, or health-clinic tonality
- No gym biceps, sports, yoga mats, or fitness cues ANYWHERE
- No sterile "supplement label" or "water bottle" layouts
- Never cartoon/saccharine, and no "kids' juice" moods

Copy DO:

- Emphasize how PEP upgrades the night—"Ready for rooftop?", "Bring the vibe. Feel good. Have fun."
- Use vibrant, positive, experiential and communal language

- Treat flavor as core to the experience (fruity, sparkling, lively)

Copy DON'T:

- Never mention protein, macros, or health stats as the reason to drink (OK to display, but NOT as emotional lead)
- Don't use sports or wellness jargon (no calories, electrolytes, discipline, etc. as headline)
- Don't talk down to the consumer or feel overly functional

Peer Brand Landscape

Primary in-line:

1. **Kin Euphorics** — social, mood-driven, experiential (see niche, trendy packaging and community focus)
2. **Lyre's** — sophisticated, non-alcoholic, premium spirits for social rituals
3. **Seedlip** — category-definer for non-alcoholic, elegant, social drinks

Positioning Fit, Drink-Type Mismatch:

- **PROTOCOL** — social, protein-alcohol hybrid (wrong for PEP: no alcohol)

Peer Brands from Other Lanes (for contrast):

- HOLY, LMNT, NOCCO, VITAMIN WELL — functional, hydration, gym, or health vibes; not for fun nights out
- BLOOM, OLIPOP, Poppi, Recess, etc. — wellness-focused, daytime, health/image focused
- ISH, Ole, Ever Tree — lifestyle upgrade, but less "party/social-first"

Anti-References:

- Any gym-bro, supplement, or hardcore functional drink branding (NOCCO, Lean Body, generic RTD– REJECT)
- drinkpep.com — different region & positioning (US, energy/probiotic); avoid name confusion
- Any minimalist/pastel wellness-juice or kids' drink

Visual Vocabulary

- **Colors:** Use only brand.json palette (green, orange, peach, yellow, cream, white); always check HEX
- **Typography:** Didot (logo), Brittany Signature (script), Montserrat (body/labels)
- **Packaging:** Think festival, nightlife, premium cocktail/mocktail meets sparkling soda; add fruit accents; ensure shelf/chiller standout

Brand Fit Rules — For All Creators

- If it doesn't look and feel like a drink *you'd order at a rooftop bar or snap a pic of with friends*—it's NOT PEP.
- If the vibe is "sports drink," "health supplement," or "kids' treat," reject.
- If nutrition or function leads the brand story (not flavor + fun), reject.
- Design and copy *must* create FOMO and social excitement, not just health utility.

Final check: If you're not sure, imagine PEP in the hand of someone on a night out, laughing, looking chic and energized—not a gym sweatband or yoga mat in sight.